



PEOPLE BORN TO SERVE: THE SOCIAL WORKER, RESCUER AND CAREGIVER

*“NEITHER THEY CAN BE MADE, NOR CAN THEY EASILY BE STOPPED FROM HELPING
OTHERS”*

THE CALL THAT COMES FROM WITHIN

There are people who choose social work as a profession, and there are people for whom service becomes a way of life. The distinction is subtle but profound. A profession may be selected; a calling is often discovered within oneself. Some human beings seem naturally unable to walk past suffering without asking, “What can I do?”

They may encounter an injured animal on a roadside, an abandoned child, an elderly person struggling alone, a hungry family, a sick stranger, a neglected patient, a distressed neighbour, or any vulnerable being whose voice is too weak to be heard. While others may see a problem and continue walking, these people feel an inner responsibility to stop.

They are social workers, rescuers and caregivers—not only for animals, and not only for human beings, but for life itself.

THEY DO NOT ASK FIRST WHO DESERVES HELP

A genuine caregiver often does not begin with a calculation of identity, status, religion, wealth, species, social position or personal benefit. The first question is frequently much simpler: “Is someone suffering, and can I help?”

That instinct can make their understanding of responsibility unusually broad. A person who rescues an injured dog may also help an injured stranger. Someone who feeds abandoned animals may quietly support a hungry family. Someone who cares for an elderly human being may also spend nights caring for a sick animal.

For such a person, compassion is not divided into separate compartments. The same human impulse can reach both the human and the non-human world.

THEY ARE NOT SIMPLY TRAINED INTO COMPASSION

Skills can be taught. First aid can be taught. Veterinary care, nursing, crisis management, communication, fundraising and social-work techniques can all be learned.

But the instinct to stop and help is different.

Education can teach a person how to serve, but it cannot always manufacture the desire to serve. Training can develop competence, but it cannot guarantee compassion. Institutions can create rules for service, but they cannot create the inner voice that says, “I cannot leave this suffering being alone.”

This is why some people appear to be born with an extraordinary sensitivity toward the pain of others. Their compassion may mature through experience, but its roots seem to lie much deeper than formal training.





THEY OFTEN CANNOT SIMPLY “SWITCH OFF”

One of the most difficult realities for such people is that compassion does not always follow office hours.

When a person becomes emotionally and morally responsible for vulnerable lives, suffering does not disappear at 5 p.m. An emergency does not wait for a holiday. A frightened animal does not understand a work schedule. A sick elderly person does not postpone a crisis until the caregiver is free. A hungry person does not become less hungry because the rescuer has another appointment.

This can create a difficult conflict between seva, employment, family, personal health and financial responsibilities.

From the outside, people may ask, “Why do you keep doing this?” From the inside, the question may feel completely different: “How can I not do it when I know that this person or animal has nobody else?”

THEIR COMPASSION CAN BECOME A BURDEN—BUT IT IS ALSO THEIR STRENGTH

The same quality that makes a rescuer valuable can also make life extremely demanding. They may sacrifice sleep, money, comfort, career opportunities, social relationships and personal time. They may repeatedly help even when they themselves have very little left.

Sometimes society notices only the visible act of rescue and does not see the invisible cost behind it.

Yet compassion should not be mistaken for weakness. The willingness to carry another being's pain is a form of moral strength. The challenge is not to destroy that compassion, but to create a sustainable structure around it.

A society should not tell its caregivers to stop caring. It should help them care without destroying themselves.

THEY NEED SUPPORT, NOT JUST PRAISE

It is easy to praise a rescuer with words such as “kind-hearted,” “selfless,” or “great person.” But admiration alone does not feed rescued animals, provide shelter, pay medical bills, arrange transport, protect vulnerable people, or give a caregiver enough time to rest.

If society truly values service, it must move beyond appreciation toward practical support.

A sustainable system may include safe shelters, community volunteers, medical assistance, financial support, employment flexibility, legal protection, counselling, training and networks of responsible people who can share the burden.

The purpose is not to replace the caregiver's compassion. It is to prevent compassion from becoming an unsustainable solitary struggle.

THE SAME PRIORITY OF COMPASSION

There is an important principle here: compassion should not be restricted by species.





A child crying on a street and an injured dog lying beside the same street may both be vulnerable. An elderly human being abandoned by family and an abandoned animal may both experience fear, hunger and loneliness. Their circumstances are different, their needs are different, and the forms of help may be different—but the moral impulse to respond can arise from the same place.

A compassionate society does not need to choose between humanity and animals. It can recognize that care for vulnerable human beings and care for vulnerable animals can coexist within a broader ethic of responsibility.

NEITHER MADE NOR EASILY STOPPED

People who are deeply inclined toward social service are rarely created by a certificate, designation or job title. The title may come later. The impulse often comes first.

And once that impulse becomes part of a person's identity, completely stopping it may be extremely difficult. Even when circumstances force them to step away temporarily, their attention may return to the suffering they have seen.

They may change their profession, move to another city, lose their resources, or face repeated discouragement—but the instinct to help can remain.

That is why I believe such people are not merely “workers.” They are guardians of a certain human value: the refusal to become indifferent to suffering.

THE RESPONSIBILITY OF SOCIETY

The greatest question, therefore, is not whether society can make more rescuers and caregivers. It is whether society can recognize the ones who already exist and create conditions in which their compassion can survive.

We should neither romanticize their suffering nor exploit their willingness to serve. A caregiver should not be expected to sacrifice every aspect of life simply because he or she has a compassionate heart.

The ideal is different: compassion should be respected, responsibility should be shared, and systems should be built around those who stand at the ground level of suffering.

A FINAL REFLECTION

Perhaps some people are born with a wider circle of concern. Their heart does not stop at the boundary of family, profession, community or species. When they see suffering, they feel called to respond.

They do not necessarily help because they expect recognition. They help because remaining indifferent feels more painful to them than making the effort.

Such people can be trained, supported and guided—but their deepest impulse cannot simply be manufactured.

And perhaps it cannot easily be stopped either.





Because when compassion becomes part of a person's character, helping others is no longer merely something that person does.

It becomes part of who that person is.

***“SERVICE IS NOT ALWAYS A CHOICE WE MAKE; SOMETIMES IT IS
THE RESPONSIBILITY OUR CONSCIENCE REFUSES TO ABANDON.”***

